# Earthquakes, October 2026

A summary of 2,226 earthquakes of magnitude 2.5 or more recorded worldwide by the USGS between 1 and 31 October 2026. 799 were magnitude 4.5 or more, and 87 started deeper than 300 km.

## 1. Summary

The largest event was a magnitude 7.7 earthquake 10 km WSW of Pitaloza Arriba, Panama on 2026-10-09, at a depth of 10 km. Most strong events sit on the Pacific Ring of Fire. Japan, Vanuatu and Papua New Guinea each had a busy month, and the deep events near the Bonin Islands, Japan region reached almost 500 km.

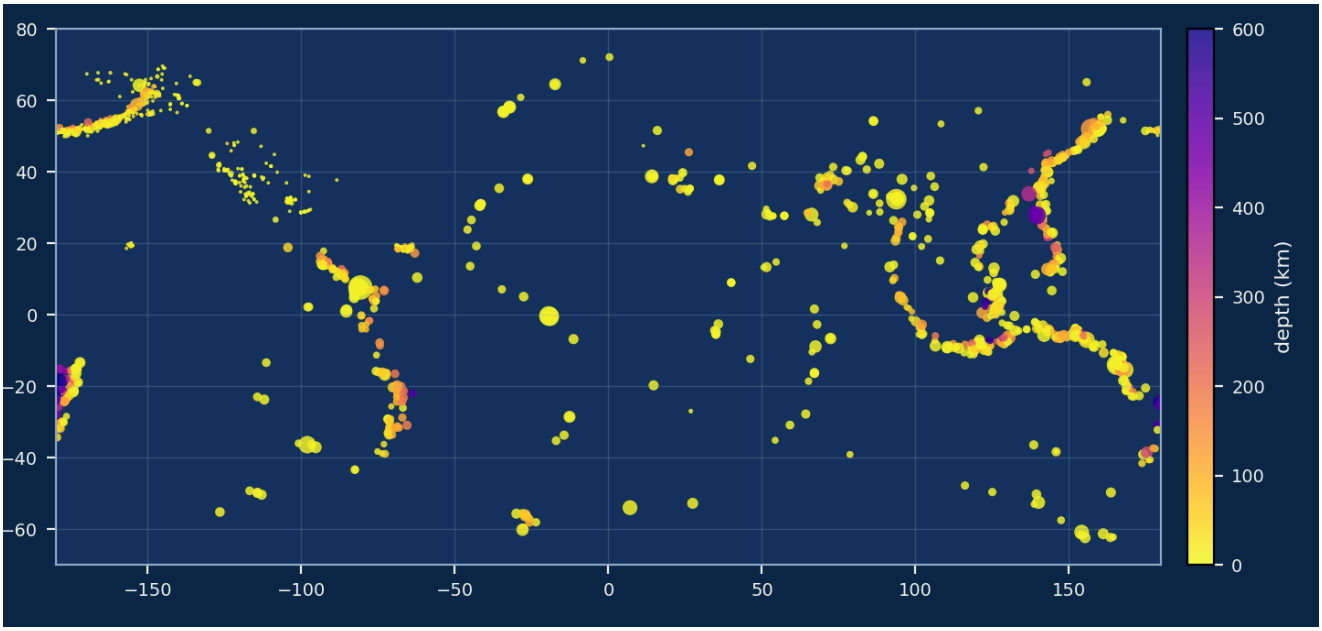



*Figure 1. Every M2.5+ event in October 2026. Dot size grows with magnitude, color shows depth.*

## 2. Largest events

| Date (UTC) | Mag | Depth km | Place |
|---|---|---|---|
| 2026-10-09 17:56 | 7.7 | 10 | 10 km WSW of Pitaloza Arriba, Panama |
| 2026-10-22 14:33 | 7 | 18 | 189 km ENE of Nagqu, China |
| 2026-10-16 03:35 | 6.9 | 135 | 72 km NE of Ozernovskiy, Russia |
| 2026-10-24 02:31 | 6.9 | 10 | 197 km WNW of Port-Olry, Vanuatu |
| 2026-10-13 12:23 | 6.8 | 10 | central Mid-Atlantic Ridge |
| 2026-10-13 05:44 | 6.7 | 10 | central Mid-Atlantic Ridge |
| 2026-10-09 20:25 | 6.6 | 10 | 13 km WSW of Río Grande, Panama |
| 2026-10-25 02:09 | 6.5 | 492.376 | Bonin Islands, Japan region |
| 2026-10-29 07:49 | 6.4 | 10 | southeast of Easter Island |
| 2026-10-08 09:00 | 6.3 | 19 | 117 km NE of Norsup, Vanuatu |
| 2026-10-20 04:20 | 6.3 | 16 | 197 km NW of Port-Olry, Vanuatu |
| 2026-10-24 02:35 | 6.3 | 10 | 170 km NW of Port-Olry, Vanuatu |
| 2026-10-11 14:07 | 6.2 | 31 | 86 km SSE of Panguna, Papua New Guinea |
| 2026-10-29 21:46 | 6.2 | 142.833 | 43 km ESE of Port-Olry, Vanuatu |

## 2.1 Magnitudes

The count of events falls about tenfold for each step of one in magnitude, as the Gutenberg-Richter law predicts.

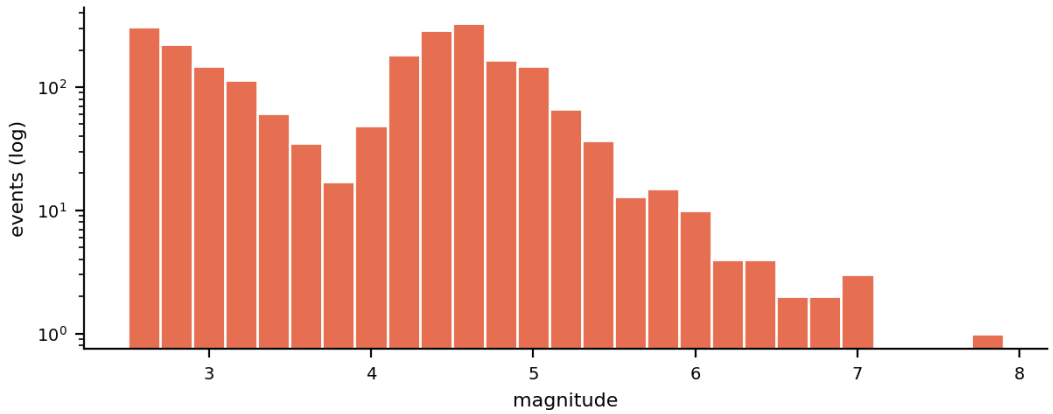



*Figure 2. Events per magnitude bin, log scale.*

## 3. Regions with the most M4.5+ events

| Region | M4.5+ events |
|---|---|
| Vanuatu | 119 |
| Panama | 115 |
| Indonesia | 62 |
| Russia | 54 |
| China | 38 |
| Papua New Guinea | 35 |
| Japan | 34 |
| Philippines | 29 |
| Tonga | 19 |
| south of the Fiji Islands | 16 |

## Appendix A. Data source

U.S. Geological Survey, ComCat earthquake catalog, query format=csv, minmagnitude=2.5, starttime=2026-10-01, endtime=2026-11-01, downloaded 2026-11-06. USGS data are in the public domain. Values are as published; reviewed and automatic solutions are mixed.